Weekly Paper Digest

Generated: 2026-08-31 12:43 Period: 2026-08-15 to 2026-08-30
Total: 36 papers (35 with abstract, 36 with PDF)

Contents

Strategy

Strategic Management Journal

1. The impact of generative artificial intelligence on innovation: Evidence from software products

Authors: Erdem Doğukan Yılmaz, Tim Meyer
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70118
Published: 2026-08-25

Keywords: digitization, generative artificial intelligence, innovation

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Management, Digital Innovation, Platform Ecosystems
- **Theories:** Knowledge Recombination, Resource Allocation, Task-based View of AI, Direction of Innovation

Abstract:

Research Summary: We study the impact of genera- tive artificial intelligence (GAI) tools on product-level innovation outcomes in the context of software prod- ucts. Specifically, we illustrate how GAI can alter the direction of innovation by shifting the activities of developers away from generational innovation and toward original innovation, which may be new to the market but not necessarily more novel than previous innovations. We argue that this shift is driven by GAI's ability to facilitate tasks in both the ideation and imple- mentation of software products, which enables some developers to create software products that were previ- ously beyond their reach, while allowing others to reallocate their effort with respect to different activities. Our analyses in the context of browser add-ons provide empirical evidence for these arguments. We discuss implications for innovation research and the generaliz- ability of our findings to other domains. Managerial Summary: Generative AI tools are changing how organizations innovate. Studying the Received: 30 September 2024 Revised: 30 May 2026 Accepted: 28 July 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70118 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–50. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 Firefox browser add-on ecosystem, we find that after ChatGPT's release, the number of new add-ons increased by 34%, driven by both existing and first-time developers. However, developers simultaneously reduced improvements to their existing add-ons by 20%, redirecting effort toward new projects. While new add-ons drew on a broader set of knowledge domains, they were not substantially different from what already existed. This suggests that generative AI helps devel- opers efficiently combine existing knowledge rather than produce truly novel ideas. For platform managers and business leaders, these findings highlight that although Generative AI can democratize product crea- tion and accelerate new product launches, it may require new strategies to maintain product quality and encourage genuine novelty. K E Y W O R D S digitization, generative artificial intelligence, innovation 1 |

`Yılmaz - The impact of generative artificial intelligence on innovation Evidence from sof.pdf`

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2. Are client ties pre-entry resources? Performance implications of client tie diversification

Authors: Heejung Byun
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70119
Published: 2026-08-23

Keywords: demand-side strategy, diversification, diversifying entry, relational capital, resource redeployment

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Strategy, Market Entry, Professional Service Firms
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Social Embeddedness, Agency Theory, Relational View

Abstract:

Research Summary: This study investigates client tie diversification, where firms enter markets with existing clients. Recognizing the theoretical basis for both posi- tive and negative performance implications, the paper adopts a question-driven approach and discovers a strong negative correlation between client tie diversifi- cation and firm performance. Using data from the US federal lobbying industry during the creation of the Homeland Security issue market post-9/11, I find that lobbying firms entering the new market with existing clients underperform compared to other firms. This underperformance is associated with over-embeddedness with clients and agency costs from dispersed client tie ownership among lobbyists. These findings challenge the notion that client ties are readily fungible and highlight relational and agency-related complexities that can lead firms to pursue value-destroying diversification. Managerial Summary: Do firms perform better when they diversify into new markets with their existing cli- ents, or by pursuing new opportunities independently? Received: 25 June 2026 Revised: 25 June 2026 Accepted: 27 June 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70119 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–32. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 This study found that firms that enter new markets alongside their current clients often underperform com- pared to those that do not. While it might seem benefi- cial to leverage existing client relationships, this approach can push firms into areas where they lack capabilities, create inefficiencies, and complicate rela- tionships with other clients, leading to weaker performance. Managers should be cautious about letting client needs drive diversification decisions. Prioritizing current clients may offer short-term gains but can limit the firm's ability to explore new markets and achieve long-term growth. Strategic choices should balance cli- ent requests with the firm's own strengths and future prospects. K E Y W O R D S demand-side strategy, diversification, diversifying entry, relational capital, resource redeployment 1 |

`Byun - Are client ties pre-entry resources Performance implications of client tie diver.pdf`

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3. Information processing, mutual understanding, and organization design in healthcare

Authors: John Joseph, Alex James Wilson, Jay Park, Daniel Chow
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70116
Published: 2026-08-20

Keywords: decentralization, EHR, healthcare, hospitals, information processing, mutual understanding, organization design

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Strategic Management, Healthcare Management, Organization Design
- **Theories:** Information Processing Theory, Coordination Theory, Shared Mental Models, Decentralization

Abstract:

Research Summary: Prior research predicts that information technology (IT) decentralizes decisions by increasing access to information relevant for decision- making. Yet this view underestimates the coordination challenges and communication costs created by interdependent work. We argue that while an IT system with its accessibility and standardization of information may facilitate the decentralization of decisions, decentralization also requires uniform interpretation and uti- lization of the information. Using a quasi-natural experiment based on the staggered introduction of elec- tronic health records (EHR) in a large US hospital sys- tem, we find EHR implementation increases decentralization, but this effect is amplified when care team members exhibit mutual understanding of other team members, task-related processes, and the clinical problem-solving context. We contribute to theories of Received: 6 July 2023 Revised: 18 June 2026 Accepted: 6 July 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70116 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–30. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 information processing, organization design, and coor- dination in healthcare. Managerial Summary: Organizations often adopt information technology (IT), expecting that better access to standardized information will allow front-line employees to make more decisions independently. Our study shows that IT alone does not increase decentrali- zation. In highly interdependent environments, such as hospitals, decentralized decision-making also requires that team members interpret and use information more uniformly. Using the staggered rollout of electronic health records (EHR) in a large US hospital system, we find that EHRs increase decentralization, with substan- tially stronger effects when care team members share a mutual understanding of each other, of core work pro- cesses, and of the clinical context. In practice, this means routine decisions move down to nurses and other care team members, freeing physicians' time for work that requires specialized clinical expertise. Our study demonstrates that organizations should pair tech- nology investments with efforts to build shared knowl- edge and common practices across teams to better ensure changes to the design of hospital care teams. K E Y W O R D S decentralization, EHR, healthcare, hospitals, information processing, mutual understanding, organization design 1 |

`📄 Joseph - Information processing, mutual understanding, and organization design in healthc.pdf`

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4. Cultivating and embracing plurality in abductive inquiries within strategy research

Authors: Prithwiraj Choudhury, Mahka Moeen, Audra Wormald
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70120
Published: 2026-08-20

Keywords: abductive reasoning, inference to the best explanation, philosophy of science, research methodology, theory development

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Research Methodology, Philosophy of Science
- **Theories:** Abductive Reasoning, Scientific Inquiry, Pluralism, Explanatory Reasoning

Abstract:

Research Summary: Abduction offers a mode of scien- tific inquiry that focuses on formulating explanations for unexplained phenomena. By building a bridge between philosophy of science and strategic management research, this article offers a pluralistic view of abduction, highlight- ing abductive triggers as the starting point in seeking expla- nations and the essential role of both creative and selective abduction in formulating explanations. Additionally, this article provides practical guidance for the design, execu- tion, and evaluation of abductive research, including the usefulness of abduction for studies not designed as abductive. We offer orienting considerations about abduc- tion's steps and elements, illustrate with examples, and out- line po- tential missteps. Abduction does not lend itself to a fixed template, and we aim to lower the barriers to using abduction in strategic management research. Managerial Summary: Abductive inquiry develops explana- tions for unexplained observations. This article con- nects philosophy of science with strategic management research to highlight the variety of forms abduction can Received: 6 January 2025 Revised: 27 June 2026 Accepted: 28 July 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70120 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–22. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 take, including generat- ing explanations in creative abduc- tion and adjudicating explanations in selective abduction. By providing strategic management researchers with greater clarity about abductive inquiry, the article contrib- utes to the development of explanatory insights that can help managers identify the causes underpinning organiza- tional outcomes and make informed strategic decisions. This contribution is relevant because strategy is con- cerned with how interdependent organizational choices and actions influence outcomes, requiring managers not only to predict what may happen, but also to explain why out- comes occur so that they can intervene effectively. K E Y W O R D S abductive reasoning, inference to the best explanation, philosophy of science, research methodology, theory development 1 |

`📄 Choudhury - Cultivating and embracing plurality in abductive inquiries within strategy resea.pdf`

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5. How data velocity changes decisions: The role of information access speed

Authors: Miguel Espinosa, Hyunjin Kim, Sergio Prada
DOI: 10.1002/smj.70110
Published: 2026-08-19

Keywords: data-driven decision-making, experimentation, healthcare, information, speed, technology

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Decision Sciences, Information Systems, Healthcare Management
- **Theories:** Information Processing Theory, Decision-making under Uncertainty, Search Theory, Data Velocity

Abstract:

Research Summary: Recent technological advance- ments have enabled more data-driven decision-making across firms. While prior literature highlights the value of using more data, there is less insight on the impact of information speed, particularly how quickly decision- makers can access it. We study how faster information access influences how decision-makers acquire informa- tion and make decisions, using data from healthcare. We examine a technology that visually displayed when test results became available, accelerating information access for 64,152 decisions by 387 physicians. Faster access allowed decision-makers to gather less but more targeted information, resolving uncertainty earlier and speeding up decisions, while ultimately improving decision outcomes by supporting more effective information processing. Our findings show that investing in data velocity can yield sig- nificant benefits through both faster and better decisions. The authors are listed in alphabetical order. Received: 4 March 2026 Revised: 4 March 2026 Accepted: 20 May 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70110 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–34. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 Managerial Summary: Our research shows that the speed at which decision-makers access information can be just as important as the amount of data available. Studying the introduction of a real-time dashboard in a hospital emergency department, we find that simply reducing delays in seeing lab results-without changing the information itself-led physicians to order fewer and more targeted tests (cutting charges by 25%), reduce patient length of stay by 13% (about 75 minutes), and improve outcomes, with lower hospitalization rates and higher patient satisfaction. The biggest gains occurred under high workload and in less common cases, where early signals are especially valuable. The key insight for managers is that faster information access does not just accelerate decisions; it improves how decisions are made by enabling more focused information gathering and better use of early signals. Investing in tools that reduce friction in accessing data can therefore increase efficiency and quality simultaneously, creating advan- tage not just through speed, but through better decision-making. K E Y W O R D S data-driven decision-making, experimentation, healthcare, information, speed, technology 1 |

`Espinosa - How data velocity changes decisions The role of information access speed.pdf`

Administrative Science Quarterly

1. Book Review: Lori Rosenkopf. Unstoppable Entrepreneurs: 7 Paths for Unleashing Successful Startups and Creating Value Through Innovation

Authors: Thomas EisenmannHarvard Business School, Harvard University, Boston, MA
DOI: 10.1177/00018392261481757
Published: 2026-08-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Education, Entrepreneurial Mindset
- **Theories:** Entrepreneurial Mindset Framework, Resilience, Escalation of Commitment, Institutional Privilege

Abstract:

Lori Rosenkopf's Unstoppable Entrepreneurs surveys seven entrepreneurial paths-Disruptor, Bootstrapper, Social Entrepreneur, Technology Commercializer, Funder, Acquirer, and Intrapreneur-each anchored in the story of a Wharton-affiliated entrepreneur.The book's conceptual spine is Rosenkopf's "Six Rs" framework (p.4), her list of defining attributes of the entrepreneurial mindset: Reason, Recombination, Relationships, Resources, Resilience, and Results.By profiling different types of entrepreneurs, Rosenkopf widens the image of who can be an entrepreneur beyond the venture capital-backed tech bro stereotype.Giving equal billing to bootstrapping, social enterprise, entrepreneurship through acquisition, and intrapreneurship expands options for individuals deciding whether to become entrepreneurs, which seems to be the book's primary audience.Also, for prospective founders, the Six Rs provide a useful mnemonic: Do they have a compelling Reason, strong Relationships, adequate Resilience, etc.? Finally, the book's case studies provide relatable role models for aspiring entrepreneurs.Readers will value the featured founders' candor.For example, one admits to having "tons of self-doubt, tons of fear" (p.20).The book's accounts of setbacks and how founders addressed them can help prepare someone who hasn't yet experienced entrepreneurship's emotional roller coaster.Unstoppable Entrepreneurs could be a good addition to an introductory entrepreneurship course syllabus.However, the book should not serve as the sole source of decision support for students asking, "Should I do this now?"A prospective entrepreneur needs both inspiration and information regarding downside risks.Entrepreneurial failure rates are very high-90 percent in one study that Rosenkopf cites.While Unstoppable Entrepreneurs spotlights founders' struggles, in the end each of the book's protagonists is successful.By contrast, failure is final for most entrepreneurs, and the consequences can be severe: deep psychological pain, personal finances in disarray, strained relationships, and stigmatization in some cultures.Rosenkopf does not position Unstoppable Entrepreneurs as a contribution to academic theory.Even so, for scholars, the book sparks several research questions.Its case studies emphasize the positive aspects of resilience.However, the confidence and optimism that underpin resilience can, in excess, yield maladaptive behavior, in particular the escalation of commitment when pivoting or shutting down a venture would be a better choice.Using Rosenkopf's typology of entrepreneurs and her Six R framework, one could explore the potential dark side of resilience: Are different types of entrepreneurs more vulnerable?How do the other Rs interact with resilience?Another possible research topic relates to the role of institutional privilege in entrepreneurial success.Rosenkopf acknowledges that the Wharton-affiliated entrepreneurs she profiles benefited from the school's prestige and access to its accomplished alumni.That observation suggests

`School - Book Review Lori Rosenkopf. Unstoppable Entrepreneurs 7 Paths for Unleashing Suc.pdf`

Academy of Management Journal

1. Research Methods Articles Designed to Advance Theory: An Update and Further Guidance

Authors: Paul D. Bliese, John Busenbark, S. Trevis Certo, Tine Köhler, Anne D. Smith, Quinetta Roberson
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2026.4004
Published: 2026-08-17

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Research Methods, Strategic Management, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Theory Building, Methodological Rigor

Abstract:

`Bliese - Research Methods Articles Designed to Advance Theory An Update and Further Guida.pdf`

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2. Resonance, Consonance, Dissonance: Explaining Divergent Responses to Entrepreneurial Setbacks

Authors: Jean-François Soublière
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2025.0122
Published: 2026-08-25

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Organizational Behavior, Stakeholder Management
- **Theories:** Cognitive Dissonance Theory, Expectancy-Disconfirmation Theory, Relational Theory

Abstract:

Gaining and maintaining the support of audiences, such as investors, analysts, or critics, is a fundamental challenge for entrepreneurial actors, who often encounter setbacks as their endeavors come to fruition. However, initially supportive audiences can react in surprisingly different ways to the same setback, leaving open the question of how and why such divergence occurs. To examine this puzzle, I conducted a process study of "backers"—a resource-providing audience—who followed the first highly successful crowdfunding campaign, from its launch in 2012 to its delivery in 2015. Although backers offered overwhelming support at first, they developed different stances as events unfolded, and diverged more drastically after an important setback. Analyzing the change trajectories of backers, I advance a model that explains how and why supportive audiences responded differently to setbacks, based on the early expectations they set (experiencing resonance), how close they felt to changing realities (cultivating consonance), and in reaction to the expectation–reality gaps that others perceived (resolving dissonance). Complementing prior insights, which emphasize collective or individual differences, the model theorizes how relational differences develop as audiences engage with entrepreneurial actors.

`Soublière - Resonance, Consonance, Dissonance Explaining Divergent Responses to Entrepreneur.pdf`

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3. The Connectivity Paradox of Flexible Team Arrangements

Authors: Stefan Berger, Hendrik J. Van de Brake, Heike Bruch, Gerben S. Van der Vegt
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2023.0869
Published: 2026-08-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Strategic Management, Team Dynamics, Human Resource Management
- **Theories:** Social Capital Theory, Multilevel Theory, Multiple Team Membership (MTM), Fluid Team Membership (FTM)

Abstract:

Organizations rely on team-based structures to promote connectivity and performance. Yet, recent research suggests that increasingly flexible team arrangements, characterized by multiple team membership (MTM) and fluid team membership (FTM), may simultaneously foster and undermine social capital in organizations. To address this connectivity paradox of flexible team arrangements, we integrate research on MTM and FTM and develop multilevel theory linking these practices to social capital and performance at the firm and individual levels. We test our theory in two complementary studies. Study 1 uses fine-grained data from a knowledge-intensive organization (n = 3,690 employees) to examine our individual-level predictions. Study 2 tests the full model with multi-source data from 106 organizations (n = 15,342 employees). Across both studies, MTM is positively related to individual social capital and indirectly to individual performance, whereas FTM shows negative associations. Study 2 further shows that flexible team arrangements (i.e., firm-level structures based on MTM and FTM) are related positively to organizational social capital and indirectly to firm performance. Our findings contribute to research on teams in general and flexible team arrangements in particular, and hold important implications for social capital theory.

`Berger - The Connectivity Paradox of Flexible Team Arrangements.pdf`

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4. Visible from Afar: Remote Employees' Collaboration Responsiveness to Managerial Requests

Authors: Hui Liao, Yasha Spriha, Qiang Feng, Li Zhu, Zhengyi Zhao
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2024.0399
Published: 2026-08-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Remote Work, Human Resource Management
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Visibility Anxiety, Trust-building

Abstract:

Amidst the ubiquity of remote work, this research examines the psychological stress and behavioral adaptations it engenders in employees, and the resultant managerial reactions. Integrating signaling theory with research on voluntary visibilizing, we propose that remote work triggers visibility anxiety, propelling employees to exhibit higher collaboration responsiveness towards managerial requests as a strategic attempt to augment their visibility. From the managerial perspective, we posit that managers trust employees exhibiting higher responsiveness more and thereby, give them higher performance evaluations and greater rewards. We obtained support for our theory through a multi-method empirical approach, which includes a natural field experiment in a technology firm using 1,098,750 objective collaboration records over an 18-week period from both experimental and control samples, and two pre-registered experiments and three scale-validation studies with working adults. Additionally, our research uncovers a less resource-intensive signalling strategy for remote employees, showing that promptly acknowledging managerial requests is nearly as effective as rapid task completion in building managerial trust. Our findings contribute to the burgeoning literature on remote work, elucidating the psychological mechanisms and behavioral dynamics for manager-employee collaborations in remote contexts, and offering novel practical implications for improving remote work relationships.

`Liao - Visible from Afar Remote Employees'Collaboration Responsiveness to Managerial R.pdf`

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5. Back to the Beginning: Rediscovering a Beginner's Mind Enhances Advice Provision to Novices

Authors: Ting Zhang
DOI: 10.5465/amj.2023.0816
Published: 2026-08-20

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Knowledge Management, Managerial Development
- **Theories:** Construal Level Theory, Beginner's Mind, Expertise Research

Abstract:

People often seek advice from those with more expertise. However, expertise can create a barrier to providing useful advice as it limits advisers' ability to communicate concretely, yielding advice that may fall short of its potential value. In this paper, I examine how rediscovering a beginner's mind—defined as a process of experiencing one's former novice state of development in a focal domain—enables advisers to give more useful advice to novices. Because every adviser was once a novice, this former self can be a valuable resource when giving advice. Building on construal theory, I test whether rediscovering a beginner's mind helps advisers communicate more concretely, generating advice that novices view as more useful and worthy of adoption. Across three main studies featuring managers and musicians, including one correlational study and two experiments (with 656 advisers and 571 advisees, generating 3,762 unique pairs), I find the predicted patterns and demonstrate how rediscovering a beginner's mind operates beyond recalling past experiences or learning new skills more generally. I discuss how these findings contribute to our understanding of how advisers can be better equipped to provide developmental advice.

`Zhang - Back to the Beginning Rediscovering a Beginner's Mind Enhances Advice Provision.p`

Academy of Management Review

1. A Process Model of Managerial Phronesis in the Age of Generative AI

Authors: Dirk Lindebaum, Natarajan Balasubramanian, Mehreen Ashraf, Patrick Haack
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2024.0582
Published: 2026-08-25

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Technology Management, Organizational Theory, Business Ethics
- **Theories:** Managerial Phronesis, Human-AI Interaction, Epistemic De-skilling/Up-skilling, Cognitive Offloading

Abstract:

> Managerial phronesis involves first-hand experience that helps managers make moral and context-specific judgments at work in pursuit of the common good. Yet, as managers increasingly rely on generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) at work, many of these first-hand experiences are replaced by synthetic outputs. While past research has investigated how human–AI interactions alter managerial agency, we do not know why, how, and under which conditions GenAI affects the development of managerial phronesis. Answering these questions is important because phronesis underpins much of knowledge use in organizations. Consequently, we develop a baseline model that advances our understanding of how phronesis emerges in the absence of GenAI, introducing conceptual innovations that explain how new experiences are generated. We then extend this model by explaining why and how GenAI shapes the development of phronesis. Specifically, we theorize how GenAI can shift the development of phronesis toward what we term epistemic de-skilling, when conditions of perceived time pressure prompt cognitive offloading of tasks, and toward epistemic up-skilling, when conditions of accountability activate managerial reflexivity. We discuss the theoretical and practical implications of our model, and articulate an agenda for future research.

`Lindebaum - A Process Model of Managerial Phronesis in the Age of Generative AI.pdf`

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2. Beyond Statically Motivated, Rational, and Atomistic Actors: Extending Tabasi-Nejad and Deutsch's "Effect of Policy Maker Motives on Their Response to Corporate Political Activity"

Authors: Jeffrey A. Chandler, Aaron D. Hill
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2026.0077
Published: 2026-08-21

Abstract not available. `Chandler - Beyond Statically Motivated, Rational, and Atomistic Actors Extending Tabasi-Nej.pdf`

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3. Search Heuristics Under Multiple Objectives: The Case of Corporate Social Responsibility

Authors: Daniel Albert, Felipe A. Csaszar
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2024.0178
Published: 2026-08-19

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Social Responsibility, Organizational Theory
- **Theories:** Behavioral Theory of the Firm, NK Landscape Model, Bounded Rationality, Search Heuristics

Abstract:

> Organizations increasingly pursue multiple objectives, yet we know little about how boundedly rational firms search for better strategies when performance is multidimensional. We use corporate social responsibility—pursuing social and financial outcomes simultaneously—as a motivating context. We distinguish multi-objective decision-making (choosing among known alternatives) from multi-objective search (discovering

alternatives through path-dependent local moves), and argue that preferences matter through the heuristics that implement them during search. In a dual-landscape NK simulation, we compare five prominent heuristics: Maximize (improve financial performance only), Combine (raise the sum of financial and social performance), Alternate (pursue one goal until stuck, then switch), Penalize (maximize financial performance while deducting shortfalls below a social threshold), and Satisfice (prioritize financial performance only after meeting a social threshold). Across varying complexity, goal correlation, and thresholds, these heuristics produce systematically different trajectories and joint outcomes. Importantly, by escaping local financial optima, Alternate often discovers "oblique" strategies that match or exceed the financial performance achieved by profit-only local search while also improving social performance. We conclude that implementing the same multi-goal preferences through different search heuristics steers firms toward different regions of the social–financial frontier, shaping both the compromises they reach and the opportunities they discover.

`Albert - Search Heuristics Under Multiple Objectives The Case of Corporate Social Respons.pdf`

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4. The Axiology of AI Agents: How Human-AI Interaction Transforms Values from Espoused to Enacted

Authors: Vern L. Glaser, Jennifer Sloan, Rodrigo Valadão, Evelyn R. Micelotta
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2024.0494
Published: 2026-08-18

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Strategic Management, Information Systems
- **Theories:** Assemblage Theory, Values Work, Human-AI Interaction

Abstract:

Organizational scholars have long recognized that espoused values diverge from enacted values. Large language models (LLM)-based AI agents—autonomous software systems capable of perceiving environments, making decisions, collaborating, and taking actions to achieve defined goals—create a novel form of this classic problem. Unlike traditional technologies where humans retain interpretive control, AI agents autonomously navigate value trade-offs, and enacted values may differ from those espoused. How does the interaction of humans and AI transform espoused organizational values? Drawing on assemblage theory, we trace values transformation across three stacked assemblages (the LLM assemblage, the AI agent assemblage, and the algorithmic routine assemblage) through three transformation moments. During configuration, inherited orientations become explicit parameters; during embedding, parameters are integrated into organizational routines; and during performance, values are enacted through the interplay of algorithmic pathways and improvised responses. Recursive feedback connects enacted outcomes to subsequent configurations, producing ongoing transformation rather than stable alignment. Our framework extends scholarship on espoused and enacted values by specifying technologically mediated transformation mechanisms produced through the interaction of humans and AI. We also extend research on values work by showing how AI agents enact values without recognizing when those values no longer fit, leaving human improvisation to diagnose where value translation has faltered.

`Glaser - The Axiology of AI Agents How Human-AI Interaction Transforms Values from Espous.pdf`

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5. Organizational Repression of Stakeholder Collective Action

Authors: Natalie Holzaepfel, Olga Hawn, Timothy Werner
DOI: 10.5465/amr.2024.0426
Published: 2026-08-17

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy, Stakeholder Management
- **Theories:** Social Movement Theory, Repression Theory, Stakeholder Theory

Abstract:

Organizations face mounting pressure from stakeholders to change practices and policies, yet scholarly understanding of how organizations manage this pressure remains incomplete. While existing research has examined various organizational responses to stakeholder pressure—including acquiescence, neglect, collaboration, and resistance—these responses have been predominantly reactive and discrete, with research overlooking a more systematic approach organizations can employ to neutralize stakeholder pressure before it emerges, and end it if it materializes. To address this gap, this paper introduces organizational repression as an integrated strategy aimed at preventing, controlling, or constraining stakeholder collective action from evolving. Drawing on the social movements and state-based repression literatures, we theorize how organizations can effectively undermine collective action by targeting its enabling conditions across three distinct phases: emergence, coalescence, and formalization. We propose five key repressive tactics—manipulating threat perceptions, closing opportunity structures, restricting resources, selectively disincentivizing recruits, and fragmenting coalitions of members and allies—and explore how organizations can implement each. Ultimately, this paper contributes to the social movements and nonmarket strategy literatures by theorizing organizational repression as a stakeholder management strategy and revealing how organizations can undermine stakeholder efforts to produce organizational and societal change.

`□ Holzaepfel - Organizational Repression of Stakeholder Collective Action.pdf`

Organization Science

1. Coworking: Finding Value Through Work Companions

Authors: Christina B. Hymer, Mark A. Maltarich, Sherry M. B. Thatcher
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2022.16202
Published: 2026-08-27

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Entrepreneurship, Future of Work
- **Theories:** Relational Embeddedness, Grounded Theory, Social Interactionism

Abstract:

Many workers have the flexibility to work across different work locations, and some choose to join coworking spaces, where they work alongside others with different employers, occupations, and backgrounds. Yet little is known about the nature of relation ships formed within this type of work location, where individuals lack shared goals and a common organizational umbrella. Thus, we ask, how do workers manage and find value from relationships within coworking spaces? Applying grounded theory techniques to col lect and analyze observational, archival, and interview data collected from 80 workers in 21 coworking spaces, we derive a theoretical model that centers around the novel construct of work companions: individuals who work alongside one another with a shared focus on work but without family, friendship, or employment relationship obligations. The cowork ing space environment, overseen by one or more space managers, provides favorable con ditions for the formation of work companions. Through interaction flexibility, coworking space members socially engage or parallel work with work companions, extracting both personal and professional value. Relational embeddedness, defined as the existence of fam ily, friendship, or employment relationships, imposes obligations that make work compan ion interactions less flexible, creating a boundary condition to these findings. Introducing the work companion construct and elaborating relationships among coworking space members offers promising avenues for future research and informs management practice on work companions, coworking, and remote work.

`□ Hymer - Coworking Finding Value Through Work Companions.pdf`

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2. Harnessing Academic Science for Corporate Technology: Interpersonal Networks and Absorptive Capacity

Authors: Sam Arts, Lee Fleming, Elena Veretennik
DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2025.20539
Published: 2026-08-25

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Innovation Management, Strategic Management, Knowledge Management
- **Theories:** Absorptive Capacity, Network Theory, Social Capital

Abstract:

> If firms conduct less scientific research internally and yet increasingly rely on science for innovation, how do they gain access to external scientific knowledge? To examine the role of interpersonal networks among corporate inventors and academic scientists in facilitating scientific knowledge transfer from academia to industry, we construct a social network encompassing nearly the entire population of life science academic scientists and corporate inventors listed on U.S. patents. To isolate the influence of interpersonal connections from the inherent characteristics and commercial potential of scientific discoveries, we leverage paper twins—scientific papers with nearly identical findings published around the same time by independent academic teams—and analyze their citations in corporate patents. Although academic science is often viewed as a public good, our findings highlight the role of close interpersonal connections—within two degrees of separation—in harnessing academic science for corporate innovation. Moreover, corporate inventors' ability to leverage these connections depends critically on their own active engagement in scientific research, as well as the alignment of their scientific expertise with the academic knowledge they seek to integrate. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2025.20539 .

`Arts - Harnessing Academic Science for Corporate Technology Interpersonal Networks and.pdf`

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3. Getting to the Heart of Conflict: Emotional Acknowledgment Reduces Negative Emotional Expression Intensity and Improves Intrateam Conflict Resolution

Authors: Christina M. Bradley, Elizabeth Baily Wolf, Lindred L. Greer

DOI: 10.1287/orsc.2024.19578
Published: 2026-08-18

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Team Dynamics, Conflict Management
- **Theories:** Emotion Management, Conflict Resolution Theory, Social Information Processing

Abstract:

> During mixed-motive intrateam conflicts, wherein members must balance cooperative and competitive motives, negative emotions, such as anger and frustration, often arise and derail effective conflict resolution. To help teams navigate this important challenge, we develop and test theory about how, why, and when responses to expressed emotions can enable effective resolution of intrateam conflict. Although prior intrateam conflict research has shown that managing these emotions is critical for conflict resolution, the focus has been on broad conceptualizations of team emotion management that aggregate across discrete emotion-response strategies with both potentially divergent effects (e.g., acknowledgment, reframing, and suppression) and different actors (e.g., members and leaders). This aggregation masks tensions and tradeoffs between different strategies and actors, and it offers team members limited guidance on how to respond to emotions during conflict. Therefore, responding to calls to focus on discrete emotion-response strategies, we identify emotional acknowledgment (i.e., the verbal recognition of another member's emotional display) as a particularly effective strategy within intrateam conflicts because it addresses simultaneously cooperative motives by helping expressers feel seen and valued and competitive motives by creating an opportunity for expressers to advocate for their unique interests and priorities. We propose and find in two laboratory experiments of 496 three-person teams that emotional acknowledgment, particularly when coming from team leaders, reduces the intensity of negative emotional expression, thereby improving team conflict resolution. Funding: The authors thank the University of Michigan and INSEAD for research funding. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19578 .

`Bradley - Getting to the Heart of Conflict Emotional Acknowledgment Reduces Negative Emoti.pdf`

Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice

1. Trust in the Gray: A Qualitative Study of Trust and Repair in Gray Markets

Authors: Dean A. Shepherd, Vinit Parida, Jason A. Colquitt, Joakim Wincent
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261470049
Published: 2026-08-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Informal Economy, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Trust Theory, Network Theory, Heuristics, Trust Repair

Abstract:

Although trust is critical for entrepreneurs in all markets, it likely differs in gray markets from that in white or black markets. In this inductive study, we find a coherent configuration of trust mechanisms in a gray market that offers new insights into how entrepreneurs can use their net- work (i.e., referrals and ''lineaging'') and heuristics (i.e., ''villageing'') to build trust in new stake- holders when trust formation is challenging and violations are costly. We also offer new insights into the practices for verifying (i.e., impromptu tests and extensive probationary periods) and maintaining (i.e., financial support) trustworthiness, as well as repairing trust.

`Shepherd - Trust in the Gray A Qualitative Study of Trust and Repair in Gray Markets.pdf`

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2. Transgenerational Intentions and the Emergence of Family Firms: Evidence from China's One-Child Policy Reform

Authors: Zhihao Ren, Cristina Cruz, Na Zou
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261472142
Published: 2026-08-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Family Business, Strategic Management, Corporate Governance
- **Theories:** Socioemotional Wealth (SEW), Transgenerational Intentions, Institutional Theory, Agency Theory

Abstract:

Are family firms born or made? We argue that firms become family-oriented as transgenera- tional intentions gain salience and reshape owners' mindsets. Leveraging China's one-child policy reform as an exogenous shock to within-family succession feasibility, we conduct a difference- in-differences analysis of 2,837 listed firms. We find that, relative to nonfamily firms, firms for which family succession is feasible increase R&D intensity following the reform, with the effect driven primarily by lone-founder firms. Our findings identify conditions under which founder- led firms transition toward family-oriented behavior, providing new insight into the ''made'' side of the born-or-made debate in family business research.

`Ren - Transgenerational Intentions and the Emergence of Family Firms Evidence from Chi.pdf`

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3. Leveling the Playing Field? Generative AI and Entrepreneurial Storytelling

Authors: Karl Taeuscher, Michael Lounsbury
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261472523
Published: 2026-08-24

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Cultural Entrepreneurship, Innovation Management
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Cultural Capital, Isomorphism, Signaling Theory

Abstract:

> Cultural entrepreneurship research emphasizes the importance of storytelling and other cul- tural skills, yet recent work suggests that generative artificial intelligence (AI) levels the playing field for entrepreneurs lacking such skills. In this conceptual article, we challenge this view by outlining how the widespread use of AI tools likely leads to systematic changes in the institu- tional norms and expectations that shape entrepreneurial storytelling. Anchored in evidence- informed assumptions about average entrepreneurs' use of AI, our theorization suggests that widespread AI adoption will lead to a homogenization in entrepreneurial storytelling—creating an evaluative environment that may require even greater cultural skills to navigate.

`Taeuscher - Leveling the Playing Field Generative AI and Entrepreneurial Storytelling.pd`

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4. Spatial (In)equality and Entrepreneurial Ecosystem Policy: A Historical Analysis of the Scottish Highlands

Authors: Shannon Harris, Mia Clarke, Anna Brattström

DOI: 10.1177/10422587261472141
Published: 2026-08-25

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Regional Development, Public Policy, Economic Geography
- **Theories:** Entrepreneurial Ecosystems, Spatial Inequality, Resource-Based View, Resilience

Abstract:

> We built a theory on how entrepreneurial ecosystem policy benefits some places within rural regions while leaving others behind. In a historical analysis of the Scottish Highlands and Islands, 1965 to 1990, we compared policies that attract external resources from outside the region with those that embed resources within local communities. We found that resource-attracting policies not only generated higher economic output but also concentrated opportunity, drained peripheral areas, and increased regional fragility. Resource-embedding policies produced lower aggregate output but greater spatial inclusion and resilience. Our historical analysis identifies spatial draining, disempowerment, and empowerment as mechanisms through which policy shapes ecosystem outcomes over time.

`Harris - Spatial (In)equality and Entrepreneurial Ecosystem Policy A Historical Analysis.pdf`

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5. Stars Are Where You Draw the Line: Reassessing Methods for Identifying Star Entrepreneurs

Authors: Boris Nikolaev

DOI: 10.1177/10422587261470833
Published: 2026-08-17

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Research Methods, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Precision-Recall Framework, Statistical Modeling, Distributional Analysis

Abstract:

> Entrepreneurship outcomes tend to be right-skewed and heavy-tailed, with a small fraction of ''star'' firms often accounting for a disproportionate share of value creation. Yet, how to define the ''star'' entrepreneurs driving these outcomes remains highly contested. In this paper, we argue that star identification is best understood as a modeling choice that depends on the research objective—no threshold rule can be evaluated

as ''optimal'' or more ''precise'' inde- pendent of what the rule it is supposed to serve—and introduce a precision–recall framework that makes the trade-offs of threshold-based approaches more explicit. Using 13 years of Inc. 5000 data linked to subsequent public listings, we then compare nine threshold-based methods, including the recently proposed quantile absolute deviation procedure by Gala and Schwab (hereafter GS-QAD) which uses a bootstrap to set a cutoff tailored to the tail of the observed distribution. Three findings emerge. First, using simulations, we show that GS-QAD' s bootstrap procedure introduces systematic sample-size bias that can confound cross-industry compari- sons. At the same time, as sample size grows, the method converges to a near-universal 17% to 20% rule. Second, firms classified as stars are 10 to 20 times more likely to become publicly traded and account for the majority of current market capitalization among publicly traded Inc. 5000 alumni. However, the choice of threshold determines a precision–recall trade-off in which no method dominates on all metrics. Finally, the probability of becoming a publicly traded company rises smoothly with revenue, with no detectable discontinuity at any threshold. We con- clude that stars are where you draw the line—thresholds should be treated as modeling choices fit to the research or policy objective, validated externally where feasible, and reported with their explicit trade-offs.

`Nikolaev - Stars Are Where You Draw the Line Reassessing Methods for Identifying Star Entre.pdf`

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6. "We Own What you Think": Institutional Constraints on Hybrid Entrepreneurship and High-Growth Entrepreneurship

Authors: Ali Mohammadi, Sergio Rodriguez-Garnica
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261473009
Published: 2026-08-17

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Institutional Economics, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Hybrid Entrepreneurship, Experimentation Theory

Abstract:

This article investigates whether institutional conditions that limit employees to pursue hybrid entrepreneurship reduce potential high-growth entrepreneurship. Using the Alcatel v. Brown rul- ing, as an institutional change that curtailed hybrid entrepreneurial activity, we show that affected states experienced a marked decline in indicators of ventures with high-growth poten- tial. Effects are strongest among early-stage ventures, consistent with hybrid entrepreneurship enabling low-cost experimentation. Venture capital investors also respond to reduced experi- mentation by increasing syndication and staging. Overall, the results show that institutional arrangements shape experimentation through hybrid entrepreneurship and, consequently, the supply of ventures capable of achieving high growth.

`Mohammadi - "We Own What you Think"Institutional Constraints on Hybrid Entrepreneurship and.pdf`

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7. Legitimacy Signals and Investor Protections: Top-Tier Law Firms in Global Venture Capital Investments

Authors: Douglas Cumming, Giang Nguyen, Anh Viet Pham, Cameron Truong
DOI: 10.1177/10422587261470048
Published: 2026-08-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Venture Capital, International Business, Entrepreneurial Finance
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Agency Theory, Institutional Theory, Contracting Theory

Abstract:

Venture capital (VC) transactions are impeded by two frictions: entrepreneurs cannot credibly signal quality to investors, and investors cannot fully protect themselves against governance risks in incomplete–contract

relationships. We argue that top-tier law firms address both frictions: sell-side firms through signaling that reduces legitimacy deficits, buy-side firms through contrac- tual expertise that protects investor interests. Using 71,129 global VC deals from 2005 to 2020, we find that top-tier law firm involvement is associated with higher ownership stakes, valuations, returns, and exit success. Both mechanisms are stronger in weaker legal environments. Results are robust to multiple identification strategies.

 `Cumming - Legitimacy Signals and Investor Protections Top-Tier Law Firms in Global Venture.pdf`

Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal

1. Decomposing venture evaluation: Learning about belief formation

Authors: Thomas Åstebro, Andrew Funck, Francesco Giordano
DOI: 10.1002/sej.70042
Published: 2026-08-26

Keywords: accelerators, belief formation, expert forecasting, information aggregation, venture evaluation

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Behavioral Strategy, Entrepreneurial Finance
- **Theories:** Belief Formation, Judgment and Decision Making, Information Processing

Abstract:

Research Summary: Evaluating early-stage ventures is diffi- cult because observable signals of future quality are weak and noisy. How closely are evaluators' assessments related to venture quality, and do their subjective judgments add to the information already available about a venture? Using more than 1600 screening decisions from a venture incuba- tor, we examine how judges use application information to evaluate ventures by rating them on a set of 14 criteria and providing an overall recommendation. Judges' beliefs as recorded in the grades of the criteria explain their recom- mendations well, but they are only weakly associated with venture quality. We document some systematic miscalibration in how criteria are weighted, though the mis- calibrations largely even out when examining the correla- tion between recommendations and quality. Within the models we estimate, beliefs and recommendations predict venture quality no better than ventures' observable attri- butes. Experienced judges are more selective but identify high-quality ventures only slightly better than novice ones. Managerial Summary: Accelerators and incubators rely on expert judges to screen early-stage ventures, but how much does this expertise add? Using more than 1600 screening decisions at a venture incubator, we assess how well judges identify high-quality ventures and where their judgment Received: 4 October 2025 Revised: 26 July 2026 Accepted: 29 July 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70042 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–36. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 falls short. We find that judges' recommendations are only modestly accurate. Judges form a recommendation from venture information by first rating a set of 14 criteria, but the beliefs formed are themselves only weakly tied to ven- ture quality. Judges also misweight the evidence: several characteristics that matter most for quality carry little weight in their recommendation, while others sway deci- sions despite mattering little. Experience helps at the mar- gin; seasoned judges are more selective and better at filtering out weak ventures, but they don't spot winners better than novices. A simple model using only the objective data that ventures report in their applications predicts qual- ity as well as the judges do. K E Y W O R D S accelerators, belief formation, expert forecasting, information...

 `Åstebro - Decomposing venture evaluation Learning about belief formation.pdf`

General Management

Journal of Management Studies

1. AI Presents Both Problems and Opportunities for Minorities

Authors: María del Carmen Triana, Arun Upadhyay
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70145
Published: 2026-08-25

Keywords: artificial intelligence, bias, minority groups

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Information Systems, Strategic Management, Corporate Governance
- **Theories:** Algorithmic Bias, Organizational Governance, Regulatory Theory

Abstract:

Abstract The recent Point article by Wu (2026) calls for a better understanding of factors that could lead to the development of AI systems that are likely to perpetuate social inequality. The Point article introduces the idea that computational beliefs interact with computational inequalities in a more systematic manner that develops AI systems which perpetuate biases. We present our counterpoint and show where we agree with Wu (2026) but also present areas that are not accounted for in the Point article. Specifically, using cases from financial services and HR systems, we highlight how algorithmic transparency driven by organizational governance and regulatory intervention can mitigate many of the issues, leading to the development of AI systems that could potentially be bias free.

`Triana - AI Presents Both Problems and Opportunities for Minorities.pdf`

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2. The Role of Rivals in Resource Picking from Factor Markets

Authors: Jason T. Sigler, Thomas Klueter, Jaideep Anand
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70154
Published: 2026-08-24

Keywords: bio-pharmaceutical industry, capability building, factor markets, resource picking, rival actions

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Competitive Dynamics, Strategic Factor Markets
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Behavioral Theory of the Firm, Herding Mechanism

Abstract:

Abstract While we know that rivals' activities in product markets are an important source of information, we know little about how firms set expectations and react to information emerging from competitors in strategic factor markets. Our theoretical framework examines this question and explains how rivals' actions in factor markets shape a firm's own resource-picking decisions. We consider that rivals can utilize a factor of production for different applications and distinguish three distinct rival actions that lead to strategic responses, which are explained by the mechanism of herding. Further, we consider that rivals' actions beyond information also convey competitive pressure that firms react to. We show that considering both informational and competitive cues determines whether firms respond by picking resources from factor markets or by building internal capabilities. The theoretical framework, hence, helps understand the role of rivals when firms decide to pursue new strategic factors and how they obtain such factors. We test our predictions using a fine-grained dataset of new product development of global bio-pharmaceutical firms from 1993 to 2018. Overall, the paper provides an important step towards a better understanding of how rivals shape firms' expectations in strategic factor markets.

`Sigler - The Role of Rivals in Resource Picking from Factor Markets.pdf`

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3. Scaling Social Impact at Tony's Chocolonely: How Interactional Dynamics Shape Social Innovation Processes and Drive Institutional Change

Authors: Janina Klein, Christine Moser, Elco van Burg
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70139
Published: 2026-08-18

Keywords: chocolate industry, cocoa, scaling, social change, social entrepreneurship, social innovation

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Social Entrepreneurship, Social Innovation, Institutional Change
- **Theories:** Social Movement Theory, Institutional Theory, Interactional Dynamics

Abstract:

Abstract Social enterprises are frontrunners in social innovation, yet our understanding of how they can scale their social impact beyond local, contained contexts remains nascent. To transform the institutional environment that gives rise to social problems, social enterprises must mobilize actors with divergent interests, values, and beliefs to change their practices –a process often complicated by incumbents who resist social innovation efforts and marginalize or co-opt social innovators. Drawing on the social innovation and social movement scaling literatures, we identify a significant puzzle: how can social enterprises avoid marginalization and co-optation while scaling their social impact? We address this question through an in-depth case study of Tony's Chocolonely, a social enterprise dedicated to eradicating child labour in the chocolate industry. Our study offers two contributions. First, we show how social enterprises can scale their social impact beyond local, contained contexts by unpacking how different types of interactions and associated scaling outcomes create moral and competitive pressures for incumbents to change their practices. Second, we show how social enterprises can fend off risks of being pushed into a niche market or of being pressured to weaken the robustness of their solution, thus avoiding marginalization and co-optation while scaling their social impact.

`Klein - Scaling Social Impact at Tony's Chocolonely How Interactional Dynamics Shape Soc.pdf`

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4. The Hidden Costs of Divestitures –Implications for the Commitment of the Remaining Employees

Authors: Jan C. Hennig, Michelle Lang, Leonie M. Brill, Natascha Loth, Michael Wolff
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70149
Published: 2026-08-18

Keywords: commitment, divestitures, employee–firm relationship, psychological contract violations, remaining employees

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Strategy, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Social Exchange Theory, Psychological Contract Theory

Abstract:

Abstract This study investigates the consequences of corporate divestitures from the largely neglected perspective of the divesting firm's remaining employees. Drawing on social exchange and psychological contract theory, we argue that divestitures –despite not involving direct job losses –can be perceived by the remaining employees as breaches of implicit employer obligations. We develop and test a theoretical framework that explains when and why the remaining employees perceive divestitures as breaches of psychological contracts, thereby weakening their organizational commitment. Specifically, we theorize that perceptions of psychological contract breaches are shaped by the organizational proximity between the divested unit and the remaining employees (i.e., divestiture proximity), with the financial performance of the divested unit and the remaining employees' reciprocity norms moderating this relationship. Using 1.8 million employee-year-level observations, we find a positive association between divestiture proximity and turnover as a behavioural outcome of reduced commitment, which is even stronger when the divested unit performed poorly and employees place greater value on reciprocity. Our findings contribute to a more nuanced understanding of divestitures by redirecting attention toward the employee–firm relationship and advancing theory on how individuals adjust their commitments after organizational restructuring.

`□Hennig - The Hidden Costs of Divestitures —Implications for the Commitment of the Remain.pdf`

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5. Mandated to Change, Pressured to Survive: How Newly Appointed CEOs Use Resonance to Manage Strategic Change–Early Survival Dilemma

Authors: Kexin Wang, Zhe (Adele) Xing, Yinuo Tang, Xiwei Yi
DOI: 10.1111/joms.70146
Published: 2026-08-15

Keywords: CEO early dismissal, charismatic visions, expressions of optimism, language concreteness, linguistic simplicity, strategic change

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Strategic Leadership, Strategic Communication
- **Theories:** Signaling Theory, Strategic Leadership Theory, Resonance Theory

Abstract:

Abstract Newly appointed CEOs often enter office with a mandate to initiate strategic change, yet such change disrupts established routines and interests, frequently provoking resistance from organizational stakeholders. This creates a fundamental leadership transition dilemma: the strategic change new CEOs are expected to undertake may also threaten their early survival. We argue that strategic change increases the likelihood of CEO early dismissal because boards, facing uncertainty about a new CEO's competence, may interpret negative stakeholder reactions as signals of weak leadership or poor fit. Drawing on the strategic communication literature, we propose that new CEOs can mitigate this tension by building resonance, defined as alignment between their communication and stakeholders' emotional concerns and cognitive frames. In particular, charismatic visions and expressions of optimism generate emotional resonance by reducing anxiety and uncertainty and strengthening affective commitment to change; linguistic simplicity and language concreteness create cognitive resonance by making change initiatives clearer and more credible. Through these communication tactics, new CEOs can build stakeholder support for strategic change even before they have established a firm power base. Using a sample of CEO successions in S&P 1500 firms from 2002 to 2015, we find support for these predictions.

`□Wang - Mandated to Change, Pressured to Survive How Newly Appointed CEOs Use Resonance.p`

Journal of Management

1. Countering Organizational Rigidity Through Operational Resource Bundling: Integrating Resource Orchestration and Dynamic Capabilities

Authors: Catherine G. Collins, Cristina B. Gibson, Martijn van der Kamp
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261471061
Published: 2026-08-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Theory, Operations Management
- **Theories:** Resource Orchestration, Dynamic Capabilities, Resource-Based View

Abstract:

As organizations mature, standardized systems help meet increasing needs for efficiency. However, this often results in resources being used in rigid ways, compromising the flexibility necessary to leverage opportunities, create value, and address customers' emerging needs. Here we address solutions to this drift to rigidity, focusing on how operational managers bundle resources to create value for the firm. Our qualitative study is based on data collected from an organization with operations across 252 locations. This data consists of 92 interviews with strategic and operational managers, ethnographic observations, and archival records. We uncovered three pathways for resource bundling that are focused on markets, customers, or organizational renewal. In each, senior-level strategic managers initially provided resources, including channels for standardization, information systems, and technical infrastructure that became rigid in their usage. When operational managers sensed this drift to rigidity, they seized flexible resources (connection, solution development, and employee development processes) to combine with the rigid resources. We refer to this as Operational Resource Bundling (ORB). Strategic managers collaborated with the operational managers to adapt how resources were used, helping to ratify, endorse, and mobilize the bundles to achieve value creation and com petitive advantage. We extend earlier work by specifying how a particular type of resource Acknowledgments: This work was funded by the Australian Research Council Linkage Scheme (LP120100690, LP130100528). We thank Mitchel Martin-Weber, Matt Barnett, Tim Jeffrey, Rod Gorrie and Roger Jowett for the opportunity to work with them, also to Roger Collins for providing early vision and support for this research. Corresponding author: Catherine G. Collins, School of Management and Governance, UNSW Business School, High St, Kensington, NSW 2052, Australia.

`Collins - Countering Organizational Rigidity Through Operational Resource Bundling Integra.pdf`

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2. Survival Is Triumph Enough: Rhythmic Resilience Amid Chronic Adversity and Acute Shocks

Authors: Ramzi Fathallah, Trenton Alma Williams, Jay Joseph
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261468322
Published: 2026-08-19

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Crisis Management
- **Theories:** Resilience Theory, Process Model, Chronic Adversity Framework

Abstract:

Contexts of adversity generate a wide range of challenges that expose entrepreneurs to com pounding hardship yet paradoxically stimulate entrepreneurship as a means of regaining con trol. Existing research often portrays adversity in two distinct ways, either as a one-time disruptive event or as a persistent condition of the same underlying hardship, overlooking how adversity increasingly unfolds as chronic adversity compounded by multiple acute shocks—a setting that characterizes the lived reality of many entrepreneurs in today's turbulent world. In such contexts, entrepreneurial resilience is not oriented toward recovery or thriving but toward enduring recurring crises, resource scarcity, and persistent uncertainty. We conducted an induc tive, longitudinal study of 32 displaced entrepreneurs living in conflict-affected regions of Iraq. Our analysis reveals a process model of rhythmic resilience in a context of chronic adversity Acknowledgments: We are very grateful to the editor, Ute Stephan, for her clear and constructive guidance through out the review process, and to the anonymous reviewers for their developmental and very insightful feedback, which greatly improved the manuscript. We like to thank our research participants for their hospitality, insights, and reflections over the years that formed the basis of this study. This research was supported by the United Nations Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO) in Iraq under project number 150328/160138. This work was also partially supported by the Samih Darwazah Center for Innovation Management and Entrepreneurship at the Suli man S. Olayan School of Business, American University of Beirut. We warmly thank the many colleagues who offered valuable feedback over the years, particularly Mathieu Bouchard, Samia Chreim, Steffen Farny, Anna Kim, Pablo Muñoz, Trish Ruebottom, and Dean Shepherd, as well as participants in the EGOS 2024 subtheme on Necessity Entrepreneurship, and the Management Research Café at the Telfer School of Management. Given the context of chronic adversity and acute shocks, our thoughts and solidarity are with the individuals, families, and communities who continue to endure displacement, insecurity, loss, and uncertainty while striving to sustain their lives, livelihoods, and dignity.

`Fathallah - Survival Is Triumph Enough Rhythmic Resilience Amid Chronic Adversity and Acute.pdf`

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3. How Followers Respond to Leader Differentiation: The Importance of Considering All Leader Differentiation Properties

Authors: Yuchuan Liu, Gary J. Greguras
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261467674
Published: 2026-08-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Leadership
- **Theories:** Leader-Member Exchange (LMX) Theory, Social Comparison Theory, Interactional Justice Theory

Abstract:

A central tenet of many leadership theories is that leaders treat their followers differently. Although leader differentiation is ubiquitous, its effects on leaders and followers are not well understood and theory and research have not simultaneously considered its three key proper ties: Leader–member exchange (LMX) differentiation, LMX quality, and LMX social compari son. We developed a theoretical model in which these three properties interact to influence followers'supervisory interactional justice perceptions and subsequently their supervisordirected deviance and supervisor-directed organizational citizenship behaviors (OCBs). To test our model, we conducted a pre-registered experiment (Study 1), a single-level, multi-wave study (Study 2), and a multilevel, multi-wave, multisource study (Study 3). Results consistently sup ported our theoretical model. First, LMX differentiation indirectly influenced supervisordirected deviance and OCBs via supervisory interactional justice. Second, the three leader differentiation properties interacted to predict supervisory interactional justice. Specifically, when LMX quality and LMX social comparison were both high, the negative impact of LMX differentiation on followers' supervisory interactional justice perceptions was the weakest and did not reliably differ from zero. Third, when LMX quality and LMX social comparison were both high, LMX differentiation' s positive indirect effect on supervisor-directed deviance, and its negative indirect effect on supervisor-directed OCBs, via supervisory interactional justice Acknowledgments: This research is supported by the National Natural Science Foundation of China (Grants # 72202091 and # 72342027) and the Singapore Ministry of Education (Grant # C207/MSS15B018). We gratefully thank the Associate Editor, Dejun "Tony" Kong, and the two anonymous reviewers for their constructive and insightful guidance throughout the review process.

`Liu - How Followers Respond to Leader Differentiation The Importance of Considering Al.pdf`

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4. O*NET Plus: A Review and Organizing Framework Extending O*NET' s Content Model in Management Research

Authors: Gavin Williamson, Emily D. Campion, Janelle L. Bremer
DOI: 10.1177/01492063261449793
Published: 2026-08-30

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Human Resource Management, Organizational Behavior, Research Methods
- **Theories:** Psychometric Theory, Job Analysis Framework, O*NET Content Model

Abstract:

The Occupational Information Network (O*NET) is a database of occupational descriptors sponsored by the U.S. Department of Labor. Since its release around the turn of the century, O*NET has taken on a broad and important role in management and organizational research as a key data source for occupational characteristics. It is common practice for researchers to combine or adapt descriptors from O*NET' s content model to measure constructs that O*NET does not capture directly (e.g., job complexity, emotional labor demands). This practice has enabled a great deal of research and poses potential extensions to O*NET' s content model, but has also come with challenges, including the proliferation of redundant measures with varying levels of validation. The purpose of this review is to synthesize the studies using O*NET-based measures and curate a database of measures with considerable evidence supporting their valid ity. In doing

so, we contribute to the literature in three ways: (1) we introduce an extended content model that we call "O*NET Plus" and offer it as an expanded organizing framework for occupational description; (2) we review evidence for the psychometric soundness of O*NET Acknowledgments: The authors thank Enrica Ruggs and two anonymous reviewers for their feedback in the review process. We also thank Tim Munyon and Rong Su for offering feedback on early versions of this work. We want to acknowledge Chad Van Iddekinge, Michael A. Campion, and members of the University of Tennessee Management & Entrepreneurship department for their feedback in presentations or informal discussions. Supplemental material for this article is available at: https://osf.io/6hc38/overview?view_only=3a3237dd18ed47d

Williamson - ONET Plus A Review and Organizing Framework Extending ONET's Content Model in Ma.pdf

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